Bicycle Maintenance Manual: Derailleurs and Gears

1. Adjusting the Rear Derailleur

The rear derailleur shifts the chain across the rear cassette.

Step 1: Shift the chain onto the smallest cog.

Step 2: Locate the barrel adjuster on the rear derailleur. Turn it counter-clockwise to increase tension if shi

Step 3: Check the High (H) and Low (L) limit screws. The H screw aligns the pulley with the smallest cog. T

2. Fixing a Dropped Chain

If your chain drops frequently, your limit screws are likely out of adjustment.

Step 1: Put the chain back on the chainring manually.

Step 2: Check the front derailleur alignment. It should be parallel to the chainrings with 1-3mm clearance.